Mental Help

mental-help-alpha.vercel.app

Mental Help

Check-in Calm Explore Sessions

By Elise

UI/UX project · Mobile-first web app

Mental Help

Notice how you feel, then do one small thing that helps.

6
feelings to pick

12s
breathing cycle

5 min
calm audio

PROJECT LINKS

Live app ↗ Figma ↗ User flow ↗ Prototype ↗ Dribbble ↗



01

PROBLEM STATEMENT

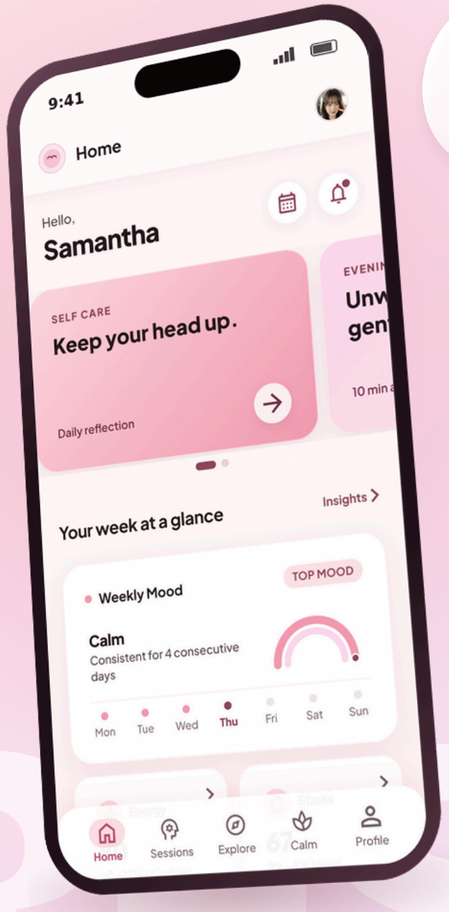
Stress builds up quietly

The problem

Everyday stress, overthinking and poor sleep build up quietly. Most people don't check in with their feelings until it gets heavy.

Who has it

Students and young working adults who juggle study, work and family. They want support, but they are not in crisis.



Thoughts racing

Stress · 67

When it happens

At night when thoughts race, before a stressful task, or after a long day. These moments leave only a few minutes to spare.

01

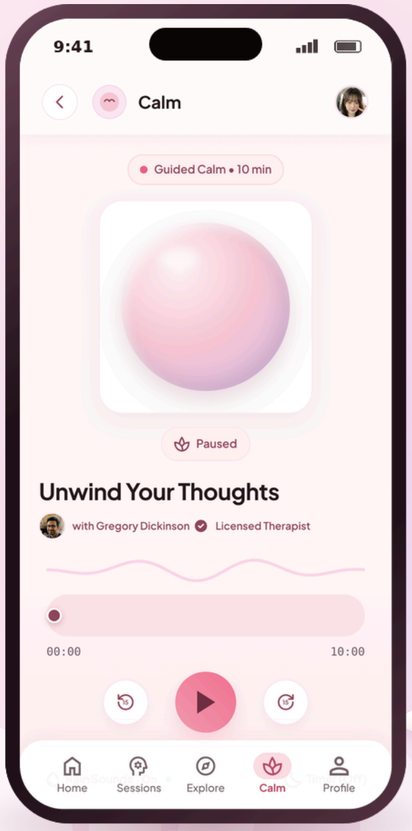
PROBLEM STATEMENT

Too slow to help

CURRENT ALTERNATIVES

How people cope now

- ✕ Scrolling social media to switch off
- ✕ Journaling apps with long forms
- ✕ Meditation apps with huge libraries and paywalls
- ✕ Waiting weeks for a therapy appointment
- ✕ Doing nothing until the stress builds up



PROPOSED SOLUTION

How Mental Help does it better

- ✓ A one-tap check-in with six feelings
- ✓ A breathing orb that slows your breath
- ✓ Short lo-fi audio with rain sounds
- ✓ Therapist sessions booked in a few taps
- ✓ A mood calendar and weekly view with your streak

CHOICES

02

TARGET AUDIENCE

Quick support, young adults



University students

Exam stress, late nights and poor sleep.

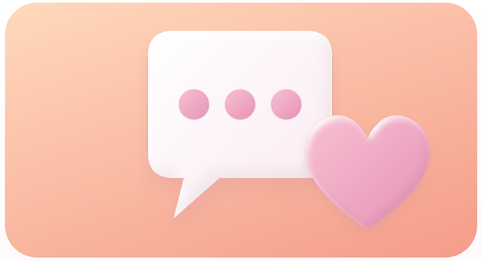
`About 18–24`



Young professionals

Work pressure and overthinking after hours.

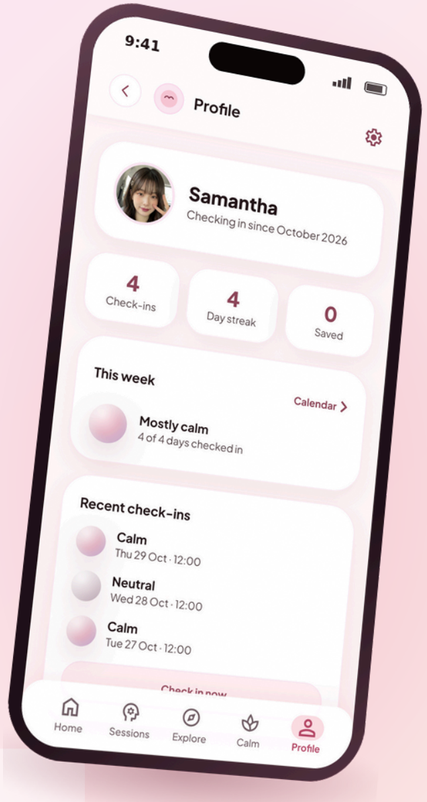
`About 23–35`



New to therapy

Curious about therapy, but unsure where to start.

`Any age`



BUILT FOR

Everyday stress, sleep and overthinking

NOT BUILT FOR

Crisis care or medical diagnosis

AUDIENCE

02

TARGET AUDIENCE · PERSONA BOARD

Meet Samantha



Samantha, 26

Junior marketing executive

Phone-first

Busy weekdays

"I know I should look after my mind. I just never find the time."

Goals

- Notice her mood each day
- Wind down before sleep
- Try therapy without hassle

Frustrations

- Meditation apps feel overwhelming
- Journaling forms take too long
- Therapy prices are unclear

Daily habits

- Checks her phone between meetings
- Has 2–5 minute gaps in her day
- Listens to audio in bed

What she needs

- A one-tap check-in
- Breathing that paces her
- Clear prices, quick booking

02

SCOPE · CHOSEN BREAKPOINT

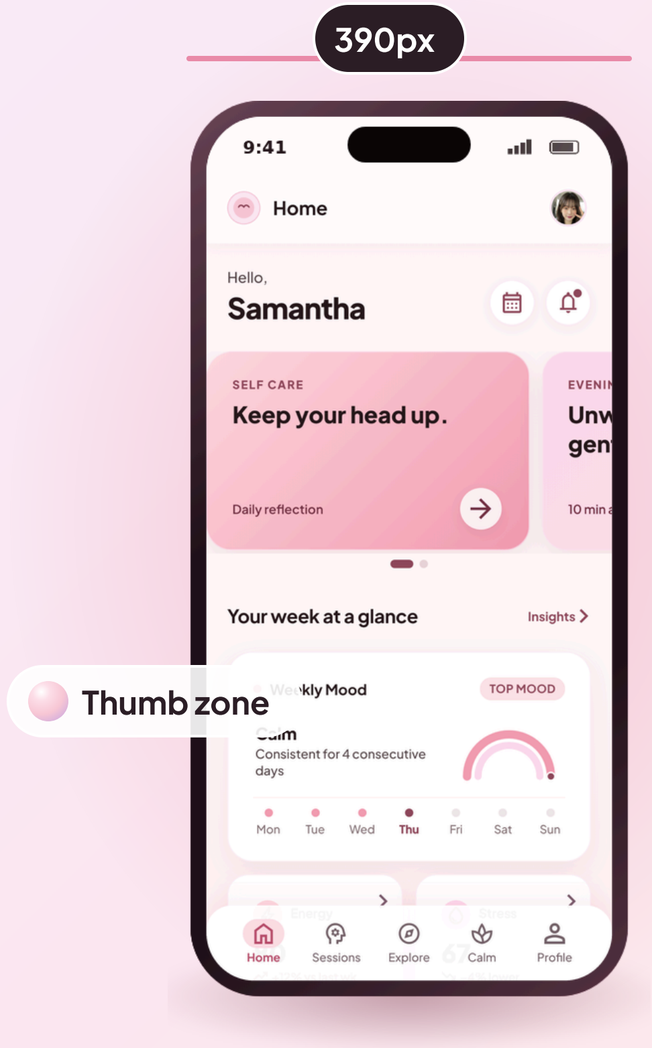
Made for one hand

BREAKPOINT

Mobile-first web app

390px

Design width. Bigger screens show a centred 430px column.



01 Thumb reach

Five tabs sit in a bottom bar. Save and Buy Now sit in the lower half.

02 Touch targets

Every tap area is at least 44×44px, even when the icon looks smaller.

03 One column

Cards stack top to bottom, so there is one clear path down the screen.

04 Calm to read

Large type, AA contrast and a reduce-motion setting in Settings.

03

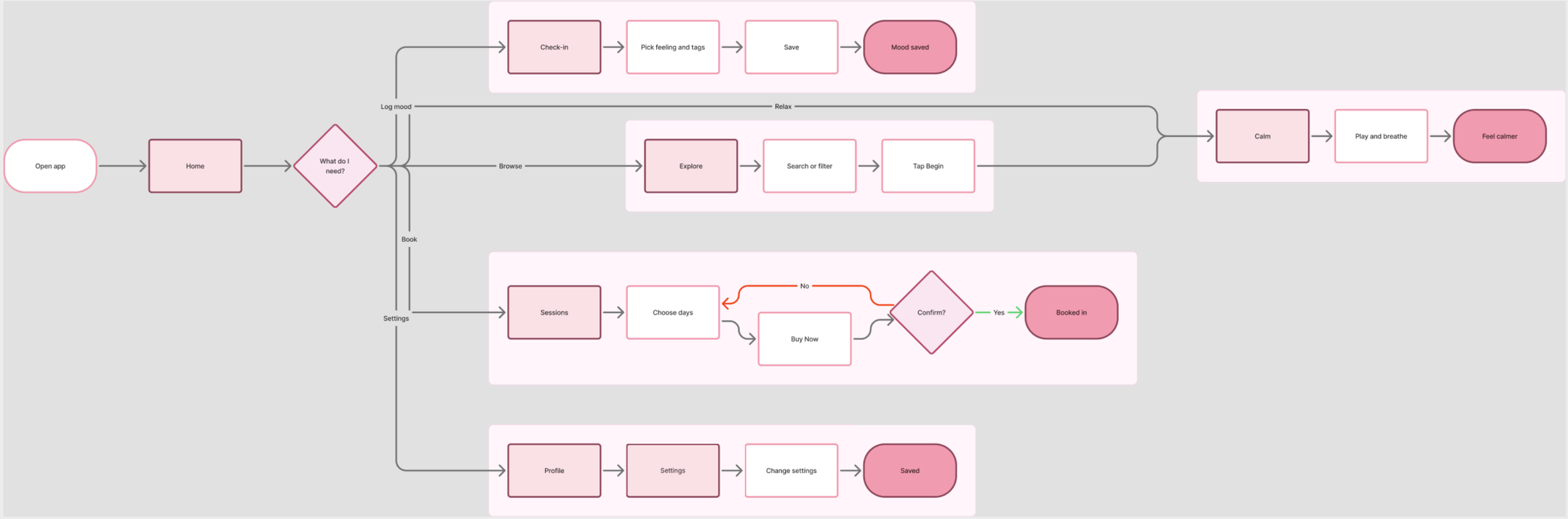
USER FLOW

Five goals, one Home

Open in FigJam →

Mental Help · User flow

FigJam



Screen Step Choice Goal reached

04

DESIGN SYSTEM · COLOUR

Soft blush, deep rose

Background
#FFF8F8
page

Blush
#FFF0F2
pills

Petal
#FCE2E7
borders

Primary pink
#F29BB0
buttons

Deep rose
#8F485B
links

Wine
#713043
on pink

Plum
#725667
stress

Ink
#26181B
headings

CONTRAST FIX

Same button, two text colours

Save Check-In →

White on pink — **2.08:1 · Fails**

Save Check-In →

Wine on pink — **4.57:1 · Passes AA**

04

DESIGN SYSTEM · TYPE & COMPONENTS

One typeface, five sizes

Aa

Plus Jakarta Sans

Shown enlarged

Regular **Bold**

ExtraBold

Display · 32/40 Bold

Mental Help

Greeting · 28/36 ExtraBold

Hello, Samantha

Card title · 22 ExtraBold

Keep your head up.

Body · 14/20 Regular

A tranquil headspace, breathing easily.

COMPONENTS

Save Check-In →

Sleep | Work | Family

3 Days | **4 Days** | 5 Days

04

DESIGN SYSTEM · CREATIVE DIRECTION

Make the mascot breathe, not pose



A · Refined Soft Vinyl

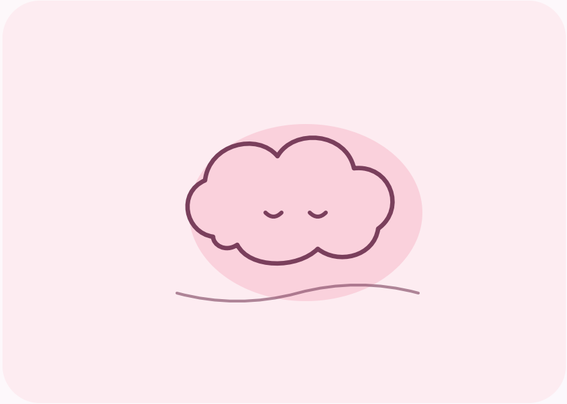
A premium art-toy cloud. Great for stills, but every state needs a new render.

Chosen



B · Breathing Light

A frosted orb lit from inside. Drawn in code, so it breathes with the audio and scales from logo to hero.



C · Warm Editorial Line

Hand-drawn ink over watercolour. Very human, but hard to animate and common in journal apps.

MASCOT

04

DESIGN SYSTEM · RATIONALE

Why the old mascot felt generic



WHAT I FOUND

It looked like every other AI mascot

The 3D renders looked like stock images and never reacted to the user. Even the logo cloud wore the “Anxious” face.

04

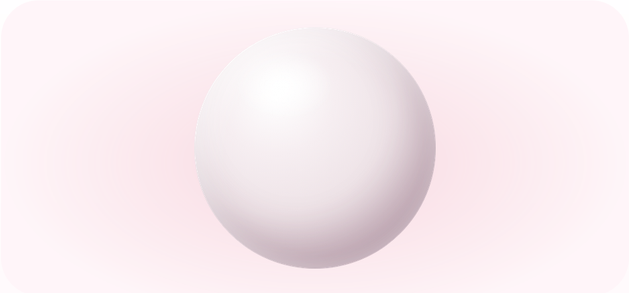
DESIGN SYSTEM · RATIONALE

What I changed



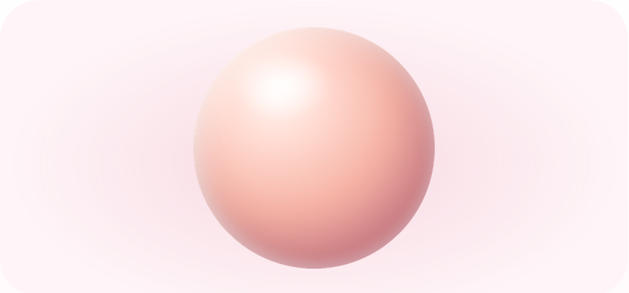
Show mood with form, light and speed

No cartoon face. It reads like a weather app or a smart light.



One body, many states

One companion across the app, so users bond with it.



Acknowledge, then soothe

Anxious and Frustrated start fast, then slow into calm.



CALM

Pacer

leads your breath



CHECK-IN

Mirror

shows your feeling



SESSIONS

Companion

one orb per day

04

DESIGN SYSTEM · EMOTION SYSTEM

One orb, six feelings

The mascot breathes instead of posing. Each feeling changes its colour and speed.



Joyful

2.6s · rises



Calm

6s · even



Neutral

8s · drifts



Anxious

1.4s · then settles



Depleted

7s · sinks



Frustrated

1.8s · then settles

FEEL

CALM BREATHING CYCLE · 12 SECONDS

Breathe in · 4s | **Hold · 2s** | **Breathe out · 6s**

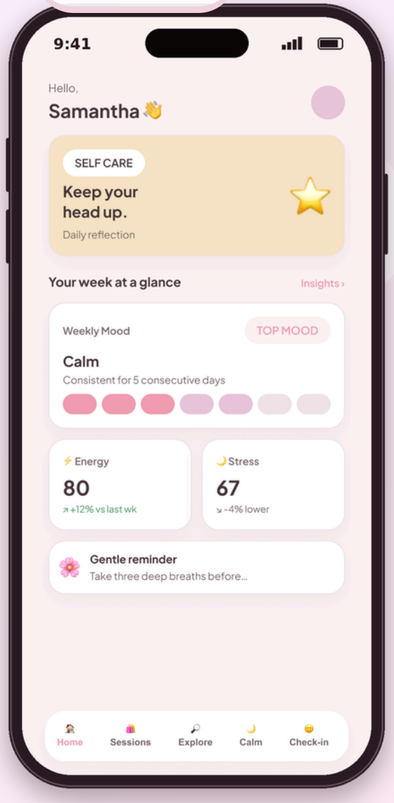
05

HTML PROTOTYPE · SERENE BLUSH

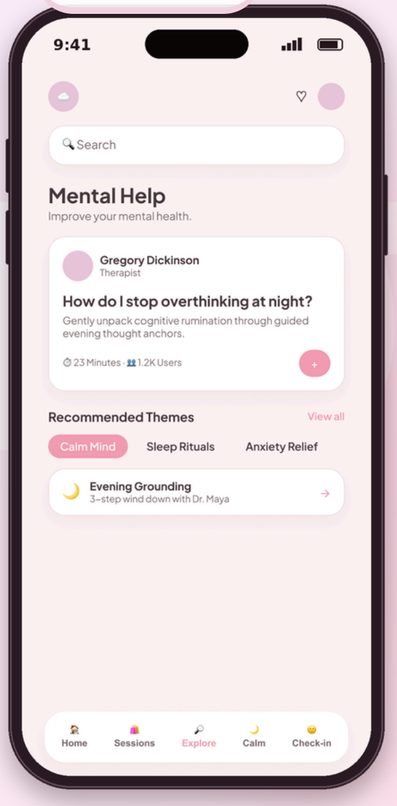
First clickable prototype

Open prototype →

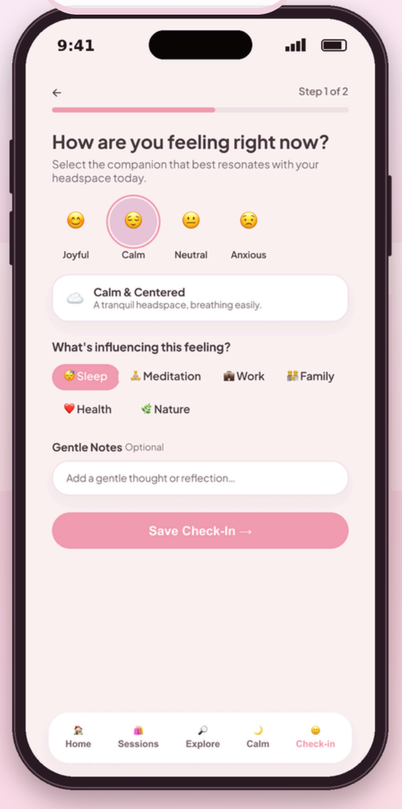
Home



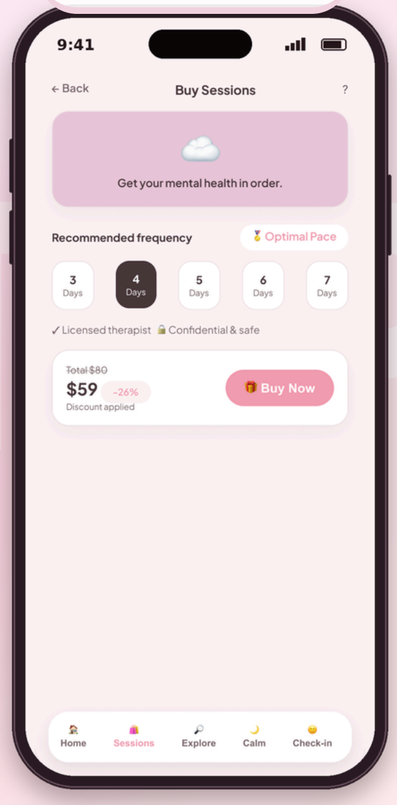
Explore



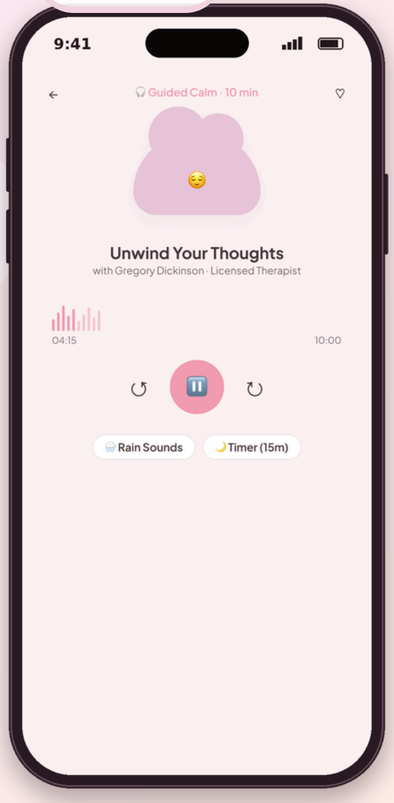
Check-in



Buy Sessions



Calm



06

REFERENCES

Where the look started

View on Dribbble →

Buy Sessions

Explore

Home



Source: “Mental Health Mobile App” concept on Dribbble

06

REFERENCES

What I kept, and what I changed

WHAT I KEPT

A soft, friendly mascot



Big rounded numbers, like 4 Days and $59



A wave slider for picking days



Floating cards with soft shadows

WHAT I CHANGED



Orange and lilac became one blush palette



The clay mascot became a breathing orb



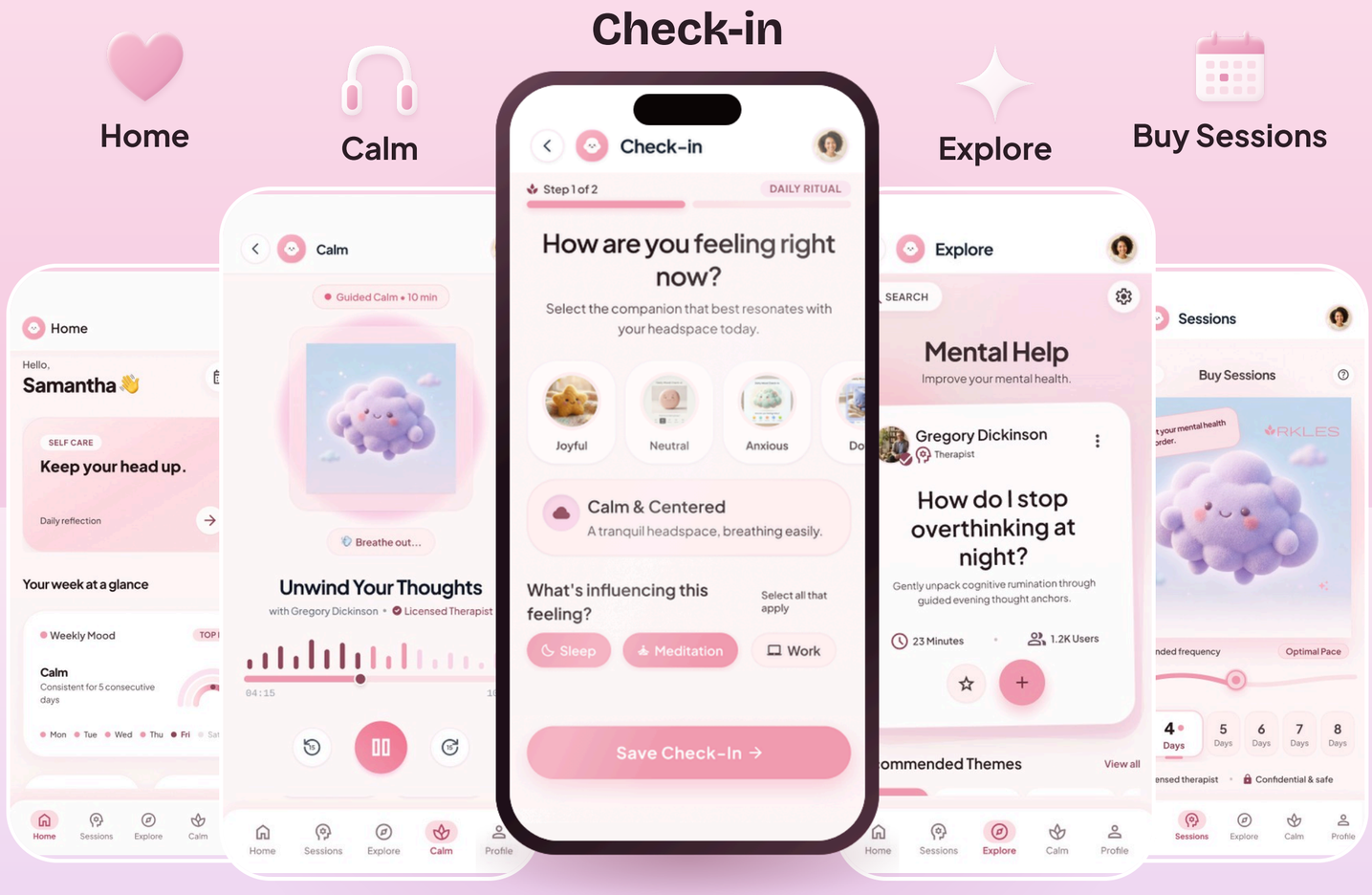
Added Check-in, Calm audio, Calendar, Profile and Settings

07

FIGMA SCREENS

Hi-fi screens in Figma

Open in Figma →

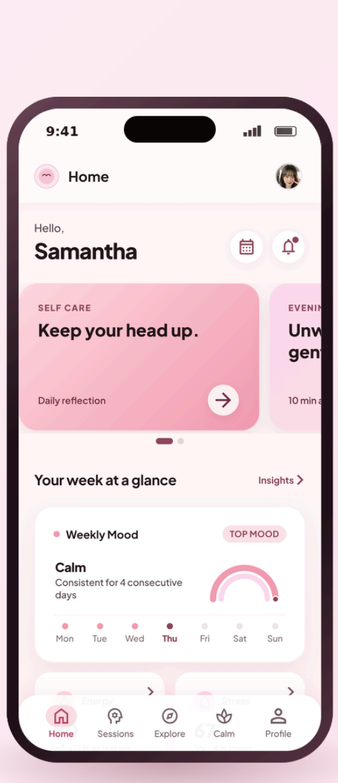


08

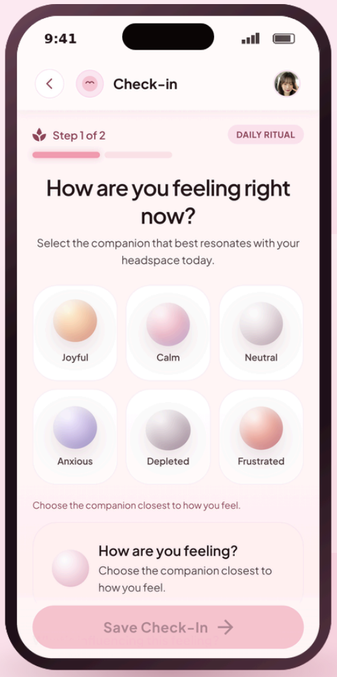
BUILT WITH CODEX · DEPLOYED ON VERCEL

Live on Vercel

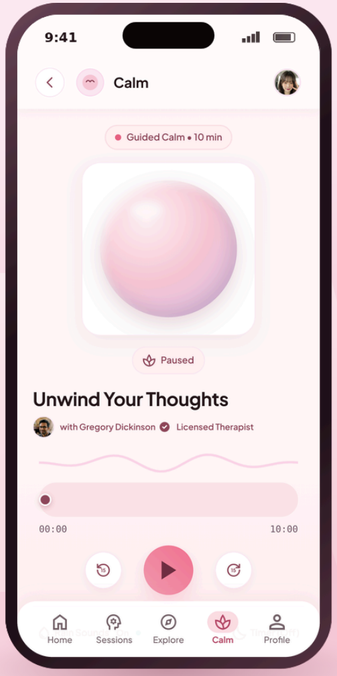
mental-help-alpha.vercel.app Live



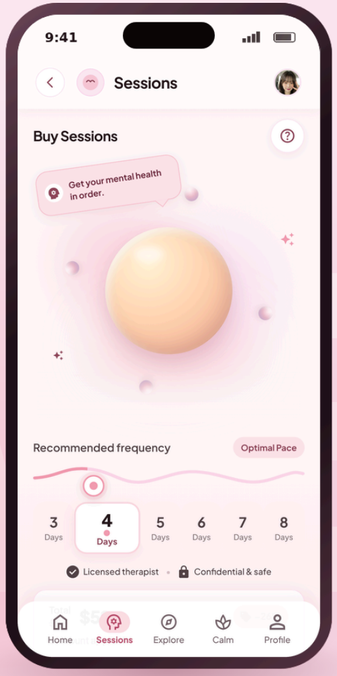
Home



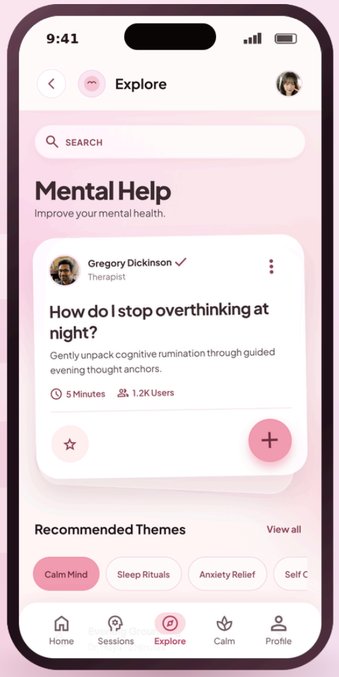
Check-in



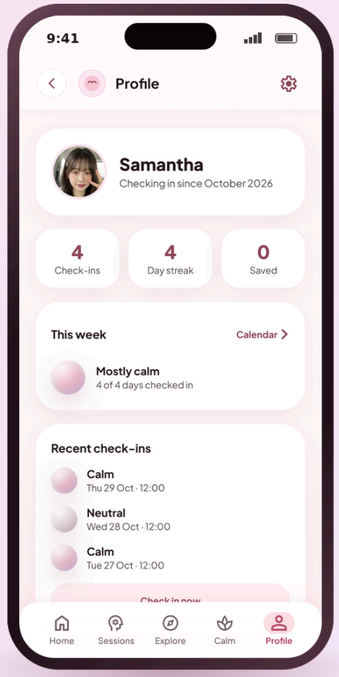
Calm



Sessions



Explore

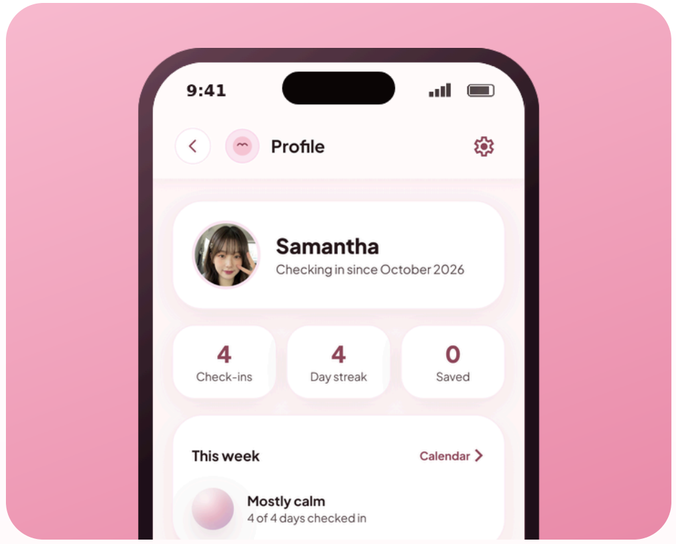


Profile

08

BUILT WITH CODEX · ADDED AFTER TESTING

Profile, Calendar and Settings



/profile

Profile shows my progress

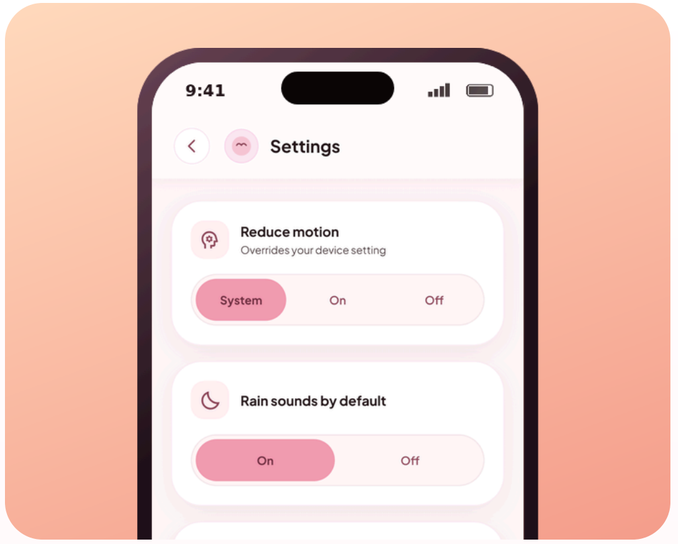
Check-in numbers, this week's mood, recent check-ins, saved sessions and my booked plan.



/calendar

Calendar shows every day

A month view of my check-ins, Monday first. Tap a day to see what I logged.



/settings

Settings holds the controls

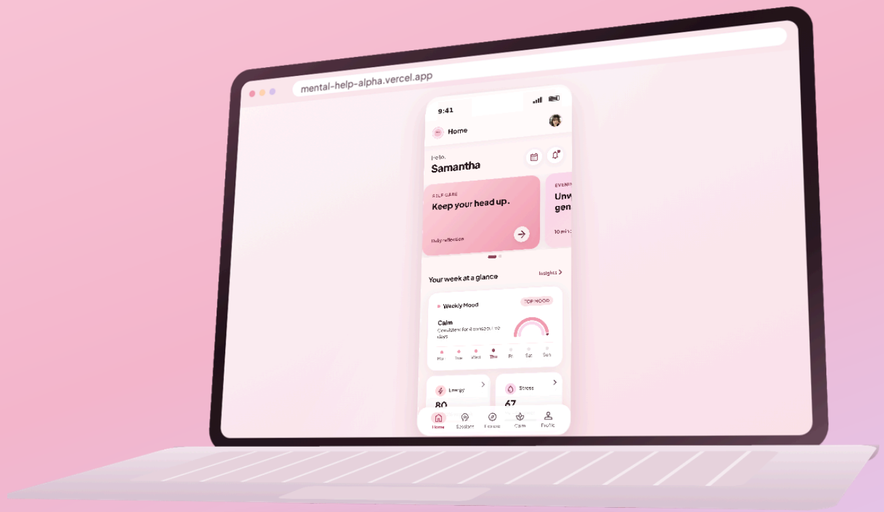
Reduce motion, rain sounds, clear check-ins and About. Opens from the gear on Profile.

09

BONUS CHALLENGES

Six bonus challenges, from code to sound

Part 1 · Build and ship




```
<Calm />
app.tsx
✓ built
```

React + TypeScript

Built with React, Vite, TypeScript, React Router and CSS Modules.

● Ready
Production
Vercel

Custom deployment

Live on Vercel, with rewrites so every link opens the right screen.

On this phone
12
check-ins

On-device data

Check-ins, bookings and saved items stay on the phone. No account needed.

09

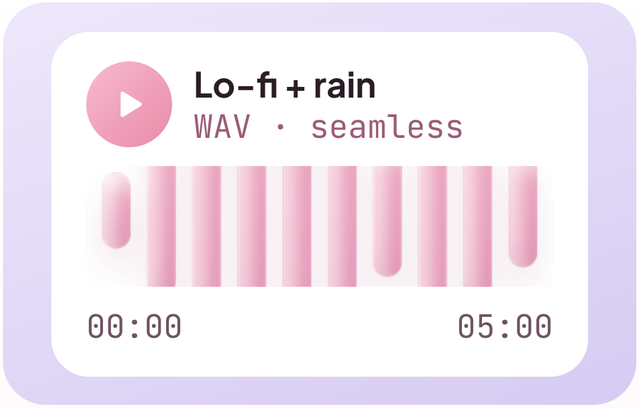
BONUS CHALLENGES

Part 2 · Motion, sound and AI



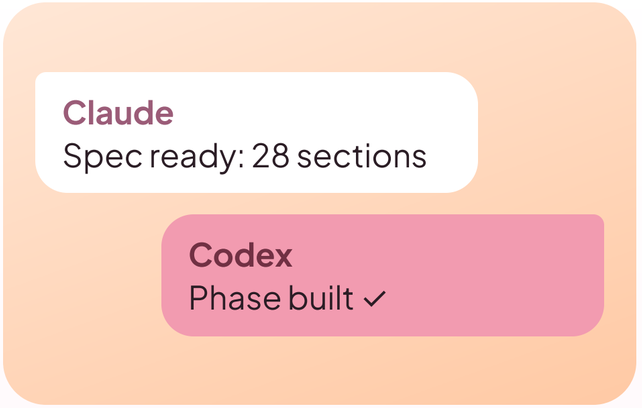
Animations

Motion drives the breathing orb, six feelings and a reduce-motion mode.



Generated audio

Eleven lo-fi calm sessions and a rain loop, all royalty-free and made with code.



AI workflow

Claude wrote the spec and reviewed. Codex built the app from it.

10

REFLECTION · NEW SKILLS AND TOOLS

New skills and tools

01

Writing a spec

A 28-section handoff for an AI builder, plus a log of 24 decisions.

02

Prompting Codex

Sending one phase at a time, then reviewing each screen before moving on.

03

React and Motion

How components, routes and design tokens turn Figma into code.



04

Vercel

Teams, projects, build settings and rewrites for a single-page app.

05

Accessibility

Measuring contrast, 44px tap areas and support for reduced motion.

06

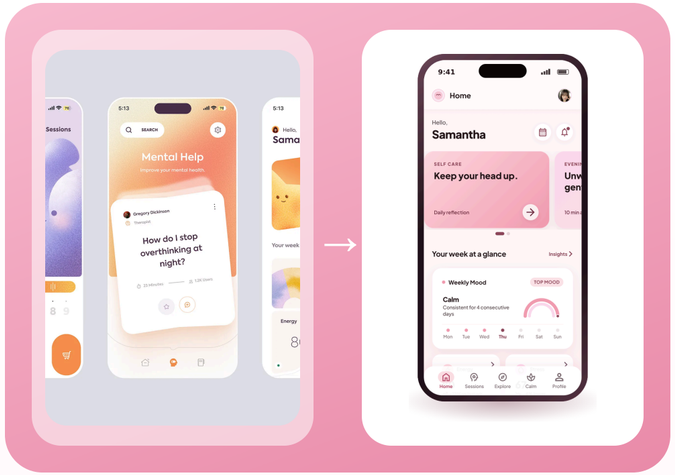
Creative direction

Critiquing my own assets and choosing one direction with clear reasons.

10

REFLECTION · DESIGN AND PLANNING HURDLES

What I had to work through

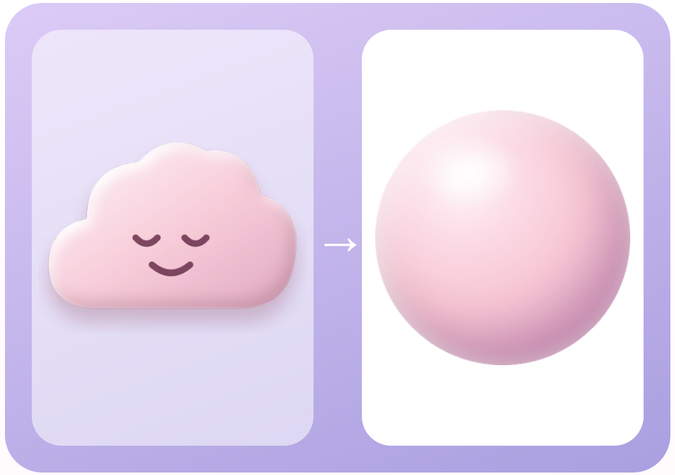


01

Finding the right inspiration

I wanted it to look and work like a period tracker: soft, simple and used every day.

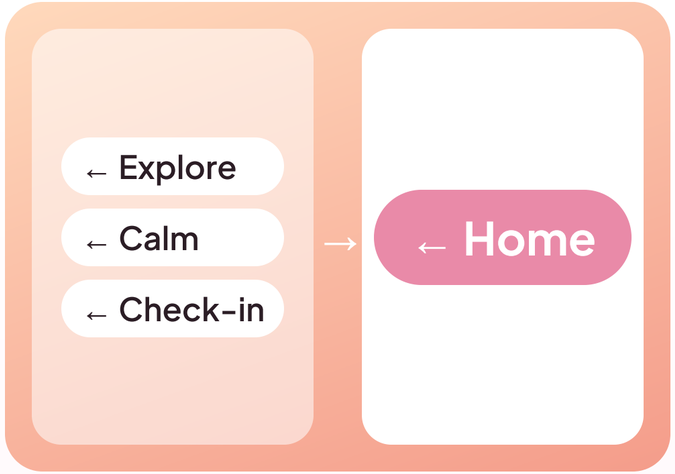
I found a Dribbble concept with that feel and built my blush look from it.



02

Letting go of my mascot

I loved my 3D cloud, but it felt generic. I chose a breathing orb.



03

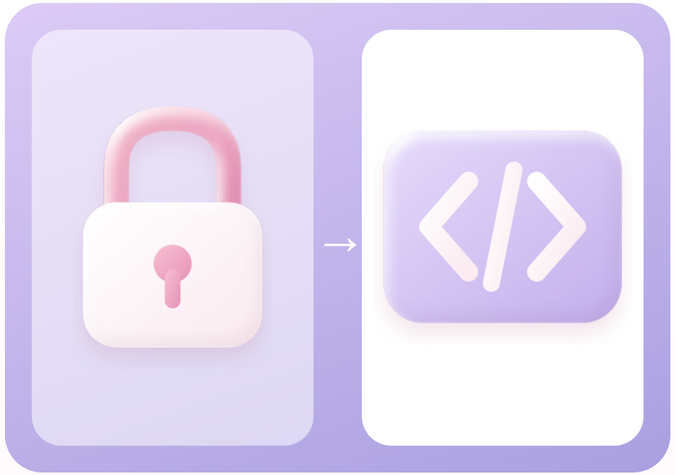
Testing my own app

Back buttons felt random, so I made them all go Home. Only Settings is different: it returns to Profile.

10

REFLECTION · TECHNICAL HURDLES

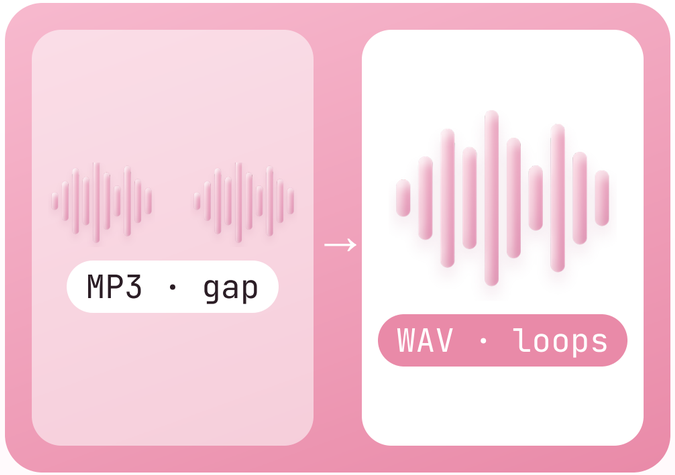
What broke, and the fix



04

Figma assets were blocked

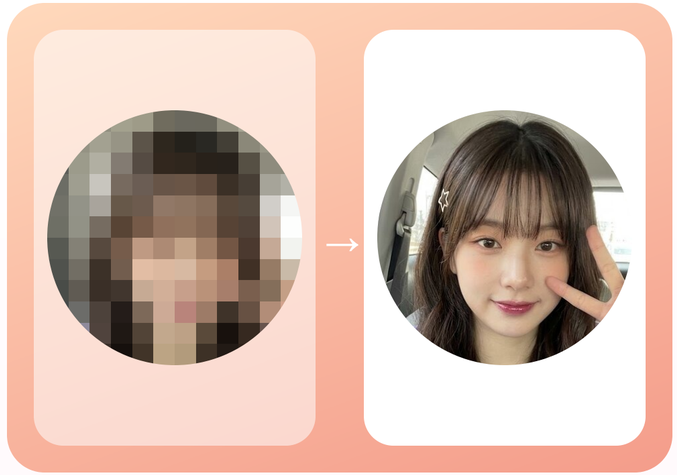
Exported icons as SVG code through Figma’s plugin API.



05

The rain loop had a gap

Switched from MP3 to WAV, which loops without a gap.



06

Profile photos looked pixelated

Replaced them with sharper portraits at four times the size.

10

REFLECTION · FIXES FROM TESTING

What I fixed after testing

07 Gradient seams on desktop

BEFORE

⚠ Pages stopped short of the frame and left a seam.

FIX

✓ **One gradient now sits behind the whole app.**

08 Home cards stuck on desktop

BEFORE

⚠ A mouse could not reach the second card.

FIX

✓ **Drag with the mouse, or tap the two dots.**

09 Doubled-up buttons

BEFORE

⚠ Two Back buttons on Sessions, plus Not now beside the X.

FIX

✓ **Kept the header arrow and the X; removed the extras.**

10 View all did nothing

BEFORE

⚠ Tapping it did nothing.

FIX

✓ **It shows all four themes, then Show less.**

11 Square outline on Search

BEFORE

⚠ A hard box appeared around the rounded pill.

FIX

✓ **A soft ring now follows the pill's shape.**

12 Check-in feelings clipped

BEFORE

⚠ The last feelings were cut off in a sideways row.

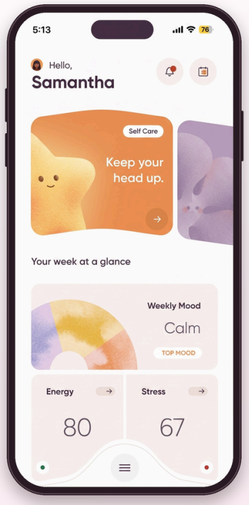
FIX

✓ **All six now sit in a 3 × 2 grid.**

10

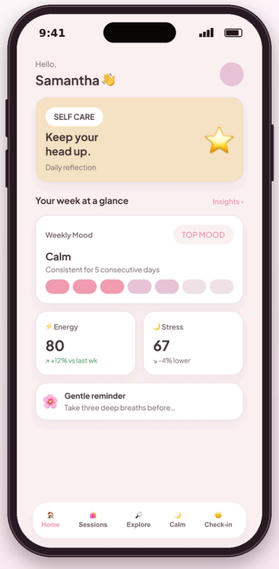
REFLECTION · WHAT CHANGED FROM CONCEPT TO FINAL?

One screen, four versions



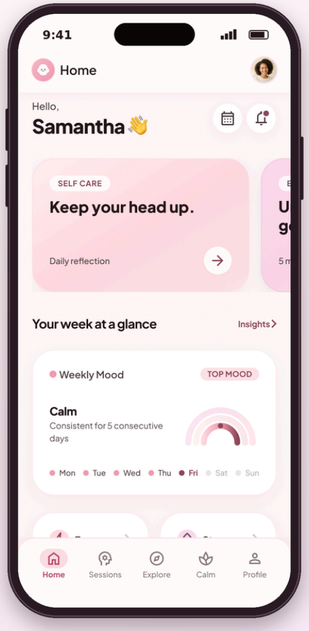
01 · Reference

Orange and lilac clay



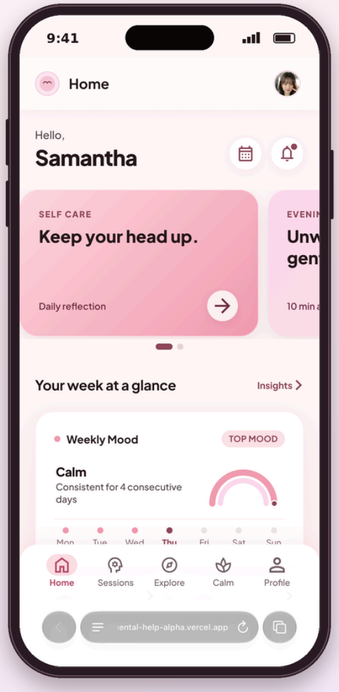
02 · Prototype

Blush with emoji icons



03 · Figma

Hi-fi blush cards



04 · Live app

Orb logo, live data

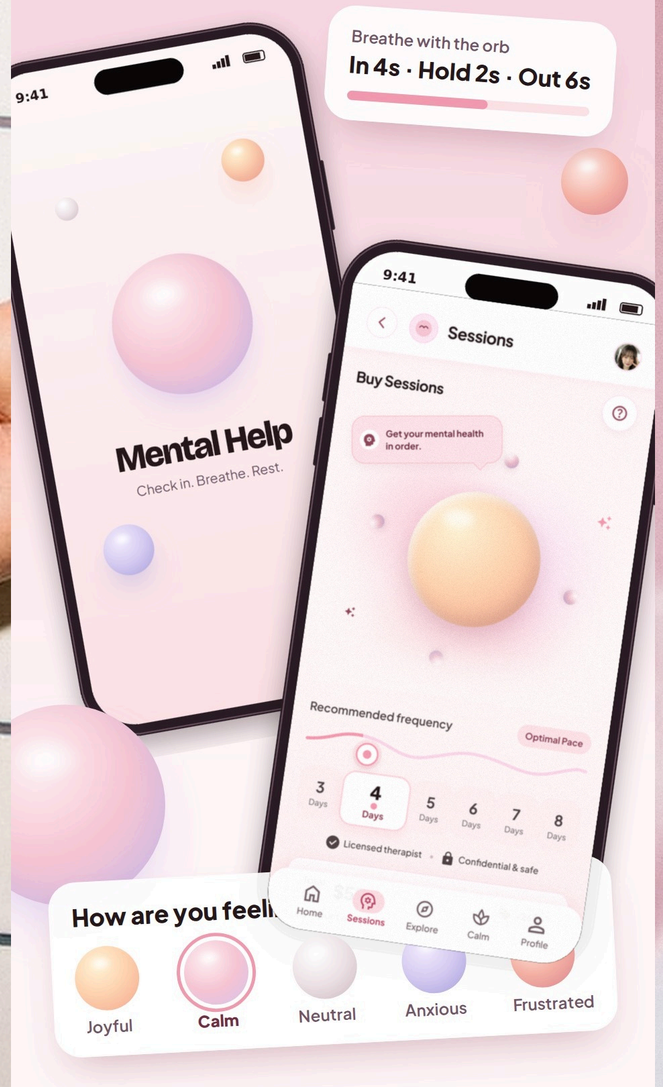
THE FINAL APP

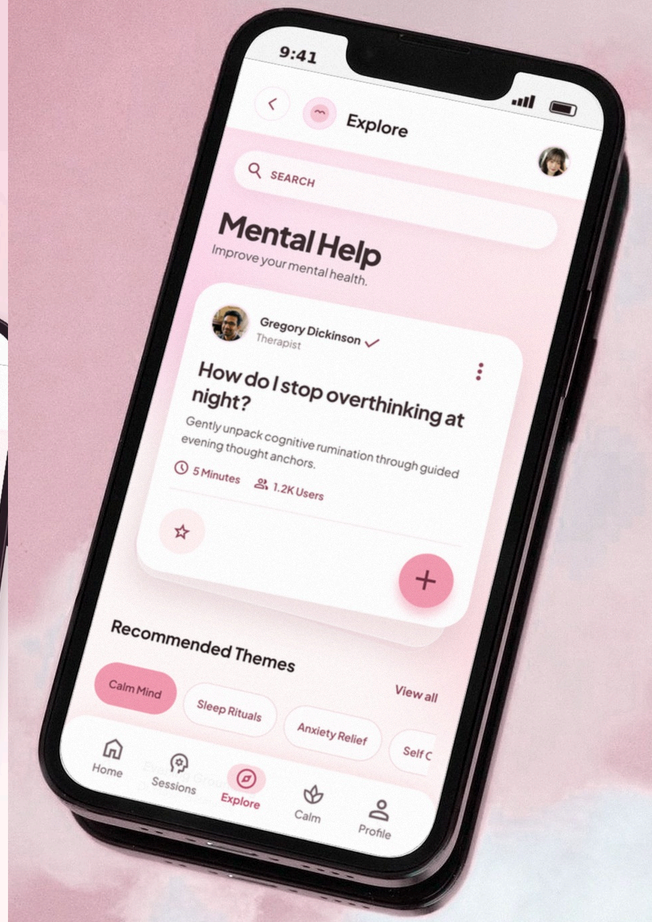
Calm, in your hand





calm





10

REFLECTION · WHAT WOULD I BUILD NEXT?

With more time, I would add...



Insights

Add Insights with mood trends over weeks, building on the new Calendar.

Accounts & Sync

Sign-in with Supabase, so check-ins follow you to any device.

Real Booking

Pick a therapist and a time slot, then pay securely.

Mental Help

Thank you

mental-help-alpha.vercel.app

